Oliver Frings

I study whether nature markets deliver what they promise. On the supply side, I price what a carbon credit delivers net of leakage, storage duration, and reversal risk; on the demand side, I measure public support for forest conservation and carbon offsetting across Europe.

Fields Environmental and resource economics · climate economics · non-market valuation · political economy of climate policy.

EDUCATION

2023 – present **Ph.D. in Economics**
AgroParisTech, Bureau d'Économie Théorique et Appliquée (BETA) · Nancy & Palaiseau, France
Thesis: *Pricing Credibility: Supply-Side Integrity and Public Support in Nature Markets*. Supervisors: Jens Abildtrup, Antonello Lobianco. Defence 10 December 2026.

2020 – 2022 **M.Sc. in European Forestry**
Erasmus Mundus Double Degree · University of Eastern Finland; University of Lleida; National Research Institute for Agriculture, Food and Environment (INRAE), BETA · Finland, Spain & France
Double degree: first year in resource economics and policy; second year in spatial and ecological modelling — remote sensing (Sentinel-1/2/3), land-cover change analysis, spatial statistics, and process-based forest models. Master's thesis (100%, with honours) published in *Ecological Economics* (2023). GPA 97%.

2016 – 2020 **B.Sc. in Forest Sciences**
Dresden University of Technology · Dresden, Germany
Forest science with substantial coursework in economics, political science, and philosophy. Bachelor's thesis on small-scale temporal and spatial variation of soil organic carbon stocks (99%). GPA 88%.

POSITIONS

2025 – present **Visiting Scholar**
Department of Land Economy (C-EENRG) and Darwin College, University of Cambridge · Cambridge, UK
Carbon-credit integrity and pricing, with Andreas Kontoleon.

2025 – present **Research Fellow**
Climate Economics Chair · Paris, France
Carbon-market design and forest-based climate policy, with Philippe Delacote.

2021 – 2024 **Research Associate, Assistant & Intern**
INRAE, BETA; AgroParisTech; University of Natural Resources and Life Sciences (BOKU), Vienna · France & Austria
Design and fieldwork for discrete choice experiments on forest ecosystem services; France–Austria research collaboration.

2018 – 2019 **Research Assistant & Intern**

Dresden University of Technology; Spanish National Research Council (CSIC) · Germany & Spain

Lab and field research on soil erosion, bio-based flame retardants, and experimental technosols.

PUBLICATIONS

2026 Chiti, T., Rey, A., Abildtrup, J., Böttcher, H., Diaci, J., **Frings, O.**, Lehtonen, A., Pülzl, H., Schindlbacher, A., & Zavala, M. A. A Review of Forest Management Practices Potentially Suitable for Carbon Farming in European Forests. *Journal of Environmental Management*, **398**, 128391.

2026 Chiti, T., Rey, A., Zavala, M. A., Manrique, S., & **Frings, O.** Maximising Forest Carbon Storage while Aligning Sustainability, Value Chains and Policy. In N. Grima, L. Walther, & F. Krumm (Eds.), *Productive and Biodiverse: Managing Europe's Forests for Economic and Ecological Outcomes*, pp. 69–99. *IUFRO World Series*, **46**.

2024 Chiti, T., Rey, A., Abildtrup, J., Böttcher, H., Diaci, J., **Frings, O.**, Lehtonen, A., Schindlbacher, A., & Zavala, M. A. Carbon Farming in the European Forestry Sector. *From Science to Policy 17*. European Forest Institute (EFI).

2023 **Frings, O.**, Abildtrup, J., Montagné-Huck, C., Gorel, S., & Stenger, A. Do Individual PES Buyers Care About Additionality and Free-Riding? A Choice Experiment. *Ecological Economics*, **213**, 107944.

Working paper **Frings, O.**, Abildtrup, J., Delacote, P., Kontoleon, A., Filewod, B., Böttcher, H., Chiti, T., Rey, A., Diaci, J., Lehtonen, A., Pülzl, H., Schindlbacher, A., & Zavala, M. A. *The Net Climate Value of Carbon Credits: Pricing Leakage, Time, and Reversal*.

Working paper **Frings, O.**, Abildtrup, J., Shanafelt, D. W., Lobianco, A., & Vacik, H. *Two Countries, One Divide: Fear of Climate Change Splits Support for Forest Conservation*.

Working paper **Frings, O.** *Classes or Continuum? A Pre-Registrable Specification Rule for Latent Class Logit Models*. Companion R package `klue` published (R-universe).

Working paper **Frings, O.** *Audited Alike, Valued Alike? Household Preferences for Public or Private Delivery of EU and Tropical Forest Carbon*.

Working paper Lobianco, A., Besic, N., Bontemps, J.-D., **Frings, O.**, & Hertzog, L. *A Hybrid Machine Learning Approach for the Prediction of Forest Stand Growth Under Different Climate Scenarios*.

AWARDS

Highly Commended Paper Award

8th Workshop on Non-Market Valuation, University of Leeds · UK 2024

Extraordinary Prize for Master's Degrees

University of Lleida, Spain · best academic record, 2021/22 cohort 2023

GRANTS

FOCUSED Seed Project Grant

AAP ARTEMIS · €15,000 (€2,500 for thesis survey expansion) 2025

Research-Stay Funding, University of Cambridge

Four competitive grants, €15,300 total · FairCarboN €7,000, DrEAM €5,300, Agreenium EIR-A €2,000, ABIES €1,000 2024 – 2026

ORION Master's Grant
French National Research Agency · €7,000, scholarship for excellent foreign students 2022

ETSEA Grant
University of Lleida, Spain · €2,500, Erasmus Mundus European Forestry scholarship 2021

COMMUNICATIONS

CONFERENCES

XXVII Annual BIOECON Conference
St John's College, Cambridge, UK · oral Sept. 2026

7th World Congress of Environmental & Resource Economists
Cascais, Portugal · oral June 2026

3rd European Carbon Farming Summit
Padua, Italy · oral March 2026

Int. Symposium on Climate, Finance and Sustainability
Paris, France · oral June 2025

LabEx ARBRE Day
INRAE Champenoux, Nancy · oral Oct. 2024

XXV Annual BIOECON Conference
King's College, Cambridge, UK · oral Sept. 2024

26th IUFRO World Congress
Stockholm, Sweden · poster July 2024

8th Workshop on Non-Market Valuation
University of Leeds, UK · oral June 2024

2nd Action versus Inaction Facing Climate Change Conf.
Strasbourg, France · poster June 2024

10th FAERE Annual Conference
Montpellier, France · oral Sept. 2023

28th EAERE Annual Conference
Limassol, Cyprus · oral June 2023

SEMINARS

C-EENRG Research Seminar
University of Cambridge, UK June 2025

POLICY ENGAGEMENT

Invited Expert
LIFE ProForPES final workshop, BOKU University, Vienna · recommendations to the European Commission on payments for ecosystem services (PES) in EU funding March 2026

Invited Roundtable Speaker
Lauterpacht Centre for International Law, Cambridge · legal frameworks for carbon-market integrity and the climate–nature crises May 2025

Invited Expert
LIFE ProForPES co-design workshop, Online · integrating PES into EU funding frameworks May 2025

Invited Panellist
ThinkForest: Ask a Scientist, Online · on the EFI report *Carbon Farming in the European Forestry Sector* April 2025

ThinkForest Report Launch
Permanent Representation of Austria to the EU, Brussels · co-author of the EFI report; spoke in the discussion that followed, held under the Chatham House Rule Oct. 2024

TEACHING

Market-Based Instruments & Payments for Ecosystem Services
AgroParisTech, M.Sc. FEN, Nancy · lecturer Nov. 2024

Introduction to Stated-Preference Valuation Methods
AgroParisTech, M.Sc. FEN, Nancy · lecturer Nov. 2024

ADVANCED TRAINING

Over 200 hours of doctoral coursework, including:

Audited lectures in environmental, regional & spatial economics
University of Cambridge, UK 2025

12th & 13th Agreenium International Research Schools (EIR-A)
INRAE, France 2024 – 2025

Summer School for Systems Modelling
International Institute for Applied Systems Analysis (IIASA), Laxenburg, Austria · 80 h July 2024

Advanced Discrete Choice Modelling & Survey Design
Choice Modelling Academy, France · 70 h 2023

RESEARCH SOFTWARE

klue R package: clustering-based initialisation, multi-start estimation, and segment selection for latent class choice models. github.com/o-frings/klue

net-climate-value Reproducible R pipeline behind *The Net Climate Value of Carbon Credits*: geospatial extraction from 30 m land-cover rasters, calibration, and Monte Carlo simulation. To be made accessible upon publication.

SKILLS & LANGUAGES

Microeconometrics Discrete choice and random utility models; welfare and willingness-to-pay estimation; maximum-likelihood estimation; experimental and survey design.

Spatial & panel data Raster and vector processing in R (`terra`, `sf`): zonal statistics over 30 m satellite-derived land-cover products, reprojection, and spatial joins; construction of annual grid-cell panels; within-unit fixed effects and permutation inference under spatial and temporal dependence; point-pattern statistics.

Risk & insurance economics Actuarial and survival models for risk pricing; discounting and net present value; Monte Carlo simulation, bootstrap, and sensitivity analysis.

Environmental & resource economics Non-market valuation; payments for ecosystem services; partial-equilibrium market modelling; carbon-market design and accounting.

Machine learning Random forest and gradient boosting; clustering (k-means, Gaussian mixture, hierarchical, PAM); multiple imputation.

Software R (Apollo, terra, sf, spatstat, mclust, randomForest, xgboost, MICE), QGIS, ESA SNAP, Ngene, Julia, LaTeX, LimeSurvey.

Languages German (native), English (proficient), French (basic).

REFERENCES

Ph.D. supervisor	**Jens Abildtrup** Researcher, INRAE, BETA, Nancy, France jens.abildtrup@inrae.fr
Host & collaborator	**Andreas Kontoleon** Professor, Department of Land Economy, University of Cambridge, UK ak219@cam.ac.uk